

Lecture 4

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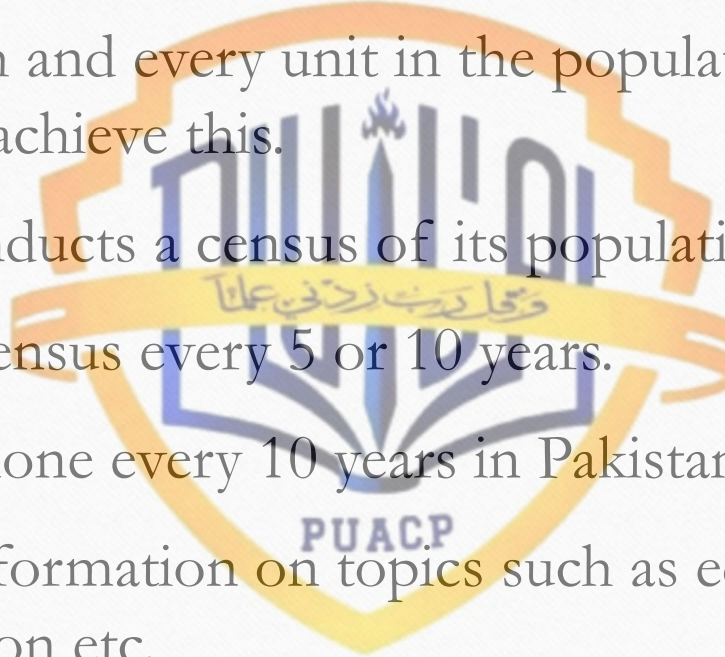
Census



Census

The Collection of information from all the elements of population is called taking a census or making complete enumeration

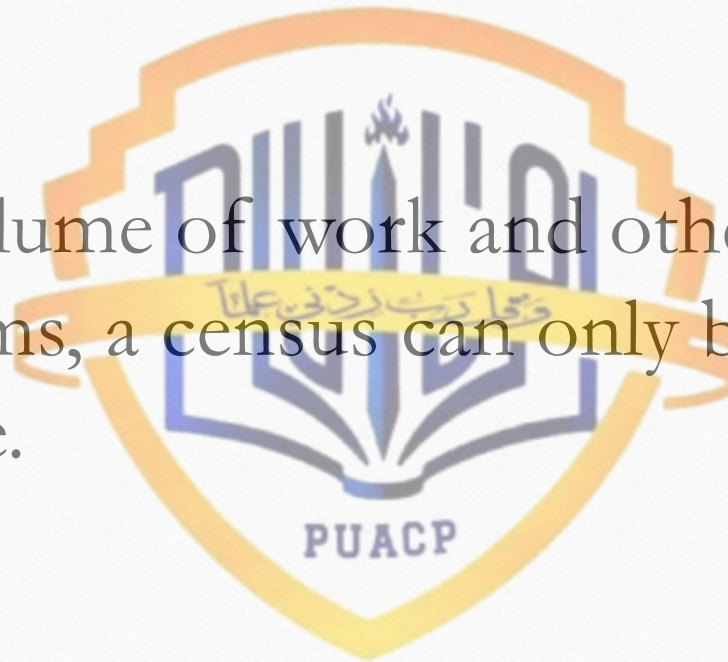
- Decisions makers need census information
- The census is a major source of high quality statistical data.
- If information about each and every unit in the population is desired, complete census is the only way to achieve this.
- Almost every country conducts a census of its population.
- Most nations conduct a census every 5 or 10 years.
- Census of population is done every 10 years in Pakistan.
- Census officials collect information on topics such as education, housing conditions, ethnicity, religious affiliation etc.
- Government uses census data to draw voting districts and allocate public funds to areas.



Limitations

- Census taking is often unnecessarily expensive or too time consuming to provide information.
- Census is impossible for infinite population
- Sometimes it is not feasible to include the whole population when elements are destroyed to obtain information
 - For example determining the burning lives of bulbs, the bursting pressure of tires, human blood etc

- A complete census is an expensive operation as it involves large number of enumerators, supervisors and administrators.
- In view of large volume of work and other administrative and economical problems, a census can only be conducted after a long period of time.



Survey



Survey

The term survey is defined as a method of collecting information to meet a definite need.

Survey

It is a data gathering strategy that is extensively used in almost all social sciences and public opinion pollings.

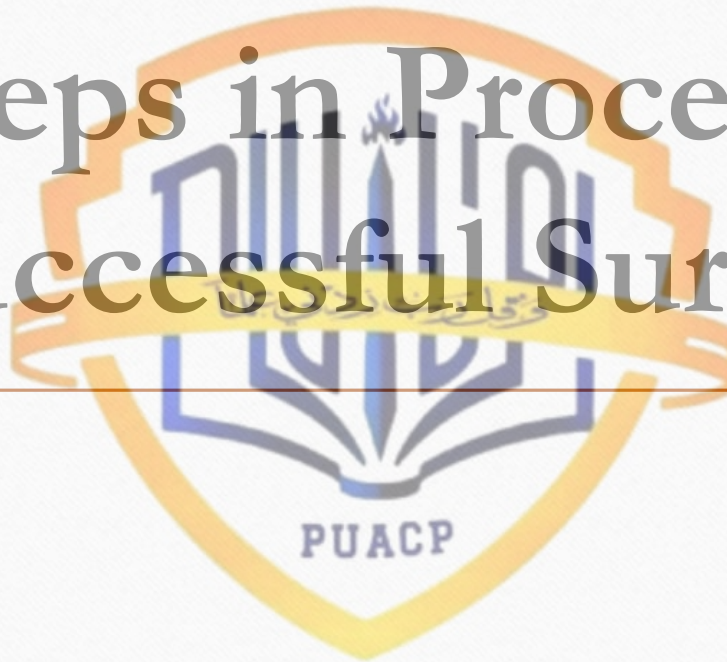
Advantages

- We can collect data with low cost and in short time
- If researcher works hard and get proper sample size then he can collect right data and solid results.
- Research can be more reliable and solid if researcher remains unbiased
- A researcher can get better results in survey research design if he creates interest of research in respondent with his honesty.

Disadvantages

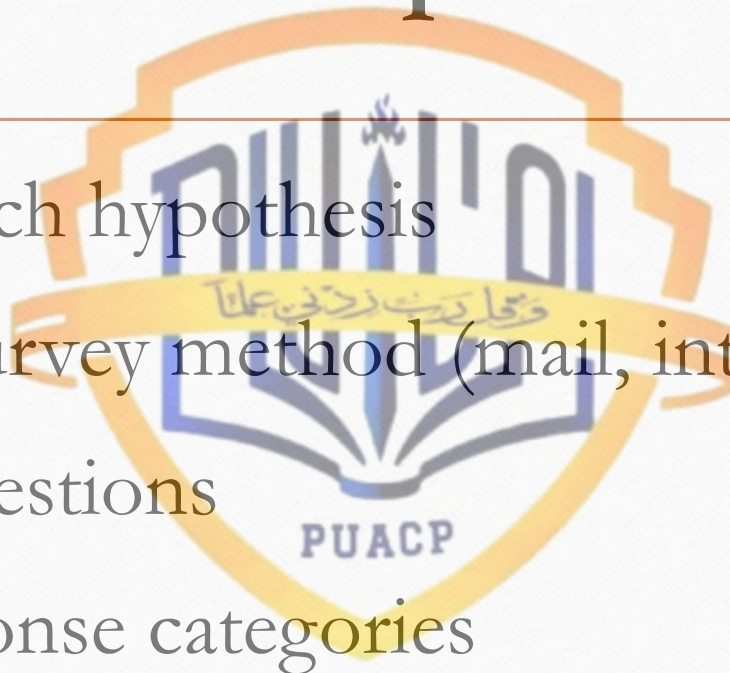
- People usually do not trust on researcher in survey research
- Researcher has to face difficulties regarding sensitive topics.
- Illiteracy is a major problem in survey research.
- Employees in official departments normally do not co-operates with researches and sometimes refuse also.

6 Steps in Process of Successful Survey



Step 1

- Develop Research hypothesis
- Decide about survey method (mail, interview, telephone)
- Write survey questions
- Decide on response categories
- Design layout.



Step 2

- Plan how to record data
- Pilot test survey instrument



Step 3

- Decide on target population.
- Get sampling frame.
- Decide on sample size.
- Select sample.



Step 4

- Locate respondents.
- Conduct interviews.
- Carefully record data.



Step 5

- Enter data into computers.
- Recheck all data.
- Perform statistical analysis on data.



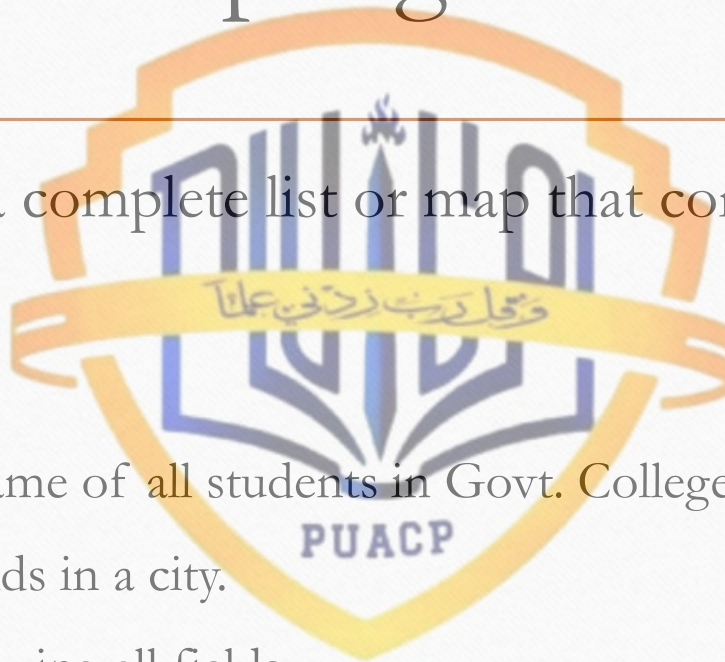
Step 6

- Describe methods and findings in research report.
- Present findings to others for evaluation and critique.



Sampling Frame

- A sampling frame is a complete list or map that contains all the sampling units in a population.
- For example
 - A complete list of name of all students in Govt. College, Gujranwala.
 - A list of all households in a city.
 - A map of village showing all fields.



Characteristics of a good sampling frame

- A good sampling frame should not contain inaccurate sampling units.
- It should be simple and exhaustive. i.e. it should contain all units and it should cover the whole population.
- It should be free from errors of omission and duplication of units.
- It should be as up-to-date as possible at the time of use.

